### c. *Neuter.*

§ **413.** The only remnant of this class is **scrūd,** *garment,* dat. **scrȳd;** gen. **scrūdes** and late OE. dat. **scrūde** were formed after the analogy of the neuter **a**-stems, and also the nom. acc. pl. **scrūd;** gen. pl. **scrūda,** dat. **scrūdum.**

## 2. Stems in -þ.

§ **414.** Of the nouns which originally belonged to this declension only four have been preserved: masc. **hæleþ** (OHG. **helid**), **hæle,** *hero, man,* **mōnaþ** (Goth. **mēnōþs**), *month;* fem. **mæg(e)þ** (Goth. **magaþs**), *maiden;* neut. **ealu,** *ale.* **hæleþ, hæle, mōnaþ,** and **mæg(e)þ** originally had the same endings as the prim. Germanic forms of **fōt** (§ **408**) and **bōc** (§ **410**). The **þ** was reintroduced into the nom. sing. from the inflected forms. The old nom. acc. sing. has been preserved in **ealu.** The gen. and dat. sing. of **hæleþ** and **mōnaþ** were formed on analogy with the **a**-declension; and beside the nom. acc. pl. **hæleþ, mōnaþ,** there also exist **hæleþas, mōn(e)þas.** Those forms which did not originally have umlaut were generalized in OE. They are declined as follows:—

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **hæle, hæleþ** | **mōnaþ** | **mæg(e)þ** | **ealu** |
| Gen. | **hæleþes** | **mōn(e)þes** | **mæg(e)þ** | **ealoþ** |
| Dat. | **hæleþe** | **mōn(e)þe** | **mæg(e)þ** | **ealoþ** |
| Plur. | | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **hæleþ** | **mōnaþ** | **mæg(e)þ** | |
| Gen. | **hæleþa** | **mōn(e)þa** | **mæg(e)þa** | **ealeþa** |
| Dat. | **hæleþum** | **mōn(e)þum** | **mæg(e)þum** | |

## 3. Stems in -r.

§ **415.** To this class belong the nouns of relationship: **fæder,** *father;* **brōþor,** *brother;* **mōdor,** *mother;* **dohtor,** *daughter;* **sweostor,** *sister;* and the collective plurals,

**gebrōþor, gebrōþru,** *brethren*; **gesweostor, ·tru, ·tra,** *sisters.*

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **fæder** | **brōþor** | **mōdor** |
| Gen. | **fæder, ·eres** | **brōþor** | **mōdor** |
| Dat. | **fæder** | **brēþer** | **mēder** |
| Plur. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **fæderas** | **brōþor, ·þru** | **mōdor, ·dru, ·dra** |
| Gen. | **fædera** | **brōþra** | **mōdra** |
| Dat. | **fæderum** | **brōþrum** | **mōdrum** |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Sing. | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **dohtor** | **swestor** |
| Gen. | **dohtor** | **sweostor** |
| Dat. | **dehter** | **sweostor** |
| Plur. | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **dohtor, ·tru, ·tra** | **sweostor** |
| Gen. | **dohtra** | **sweostra** |
| Dat. | **dohtrum** | **sweostrum** |

The prim. Germanic forms of **fæder** were: Sing. nom. ***faðēr** (Gr. πατήρ), acc. ***faðerun** (Gr. πατέρα), gen. ***faðras** (Gr. πατρός, Lat. **patris**), dat. ***faðri** (Gr. πατρί); Plur. nom. ***faðeriz** (Gr. πατέρες), acc. ***faðrunz** (cp. Goth. **brōþruns**), gen. ***faðrõn** (Gr. πατρῶν), dat. ***faðrumiz** (cp. Goth. **brōþrum**). The OE. nom. acc. and gen. sing. **fæder** is normally developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms. On the gen. **fæder** from ***faðras**, see § **219**; **fæderes** was formed on analogy with the **a**-stems. The prim. Germanic pl. forms (except the acc.) regularly became ***fæder, fædra, fædrum,** the last two of which were common in the oldest period of the language; then later **·er** was levelled out into the gen. and dat., and the nom. pl. ***fæder** became **fæd(e)ras** on analogy with the **a**-stems.

The prim. Germanic case endings of **brōþor, mōdor, dohtor,** and **sweostor** were the same as those of **fæder**

except that **brōþor** and **sweostor** having originally the chief accent on the stem had **-raz** in the gen. singular. The dat. forms ***þrōþri, *mōđri, *đoχtri** (older ***đuχtri**) with **o** from the nom. acc. and gen., ***swestri** (older ***swistri**) with **e** from the nom. acc. and gen., regularly became **brēþer, mēder, dehter, sweostor** (cp. § **219**). In late OE. the dat. **mēder, dehter** were often used for the gen. and vice versa. The gen. sing. ***þrōþraz, *mōđras, *đoχtras, *swestraz,** regularly became **brōþor, mōdor, dohtor, sweostor** (§ **219**). The gen. and dat. pl. were regularly developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms. The nom. sing. and pl. were in prim. OE. ***brōþer, *mōder, *doχter, *swestor,** then **-er** became **-or** (older **-ur**) through the influence of the guttural vowel in the stem (cp. § **222**), but the ending **-er** (rarely **-ar**) often occurs both in early and late OE. **sweostor** had **-or** in prim. Germanic, as nom. sing. ***swesor,** Indg. ***swesōr,** pl. ***swesoriz,** Indg. ***swesores;** the **t** was developed between the **s** and **r** in the gen. sing. ***swestraz,** pl. ***swestrõn,** and then became generalized (§ **240**).

**gebrōþor** and **gesweostor** were originally neuter collective nouns and were declined like **wīte** (§ **355**), whence the plural endings **gebrōþru, gesweostru, -tra,** which were afterwards extended to the plural of **mōdor** and **dohtor.**

### 4. The Masculine Stems in -nd.

§ **416.** Sing.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Nom. Acc. | **frēond,** *friend* | **wīgend,** *warrior* |
| Gen. | **frēondes** | **wīgendes** |
| Dat. | **frīend, frēonde** | **wīgende** |

Plur.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Nom. Acc. | **frīend, frēond, -as** | **wīgend, -e, -as** |
| Gen. | **frēonda** | **wīgendra** |
| Dat. | **frēondum** | **wīgendum** |

The nouns of this declension are old present participles, like Lat. **ferēns,** *bearing*, gen. **ferentis,** and originally had the same case endings as the other consonantal stems. But in OE. as in the other Germanic languages they underwent various new formations. The OE. present participles had passed over into the **ja**-declension of adjectives (§§ **433–4**) in the oldest period of the language.

The nom. sing. was a new formation with **d** from the inflected forms, cp. Lat. **ferēns** from ***ferenss** older ***ferents** (§ **240**). The gen. sing. **frēondes, wīgendes,** dat. **frēonde, wīgende,** nom. acc. pl. **frēondas, wīgendas** were formed after the analogy of the masc. **a**-stems. The dat. **frīend** with umlaut is from ***frīondi** older ***frijōndi**; and the nom. pl. **frīend** is also from ***frīondi** older ***frijōndiz** (Goth. **frijōnds**). The nom. and gen. pl. endings **-e, -ra** are adjectival (§ **424**).

§ **417.** Like **frēond** are declined **fēond,** *enemy*; **tēond,** *accuser*; the compound noun **gōddōnd** (pl. **-dōnd,** beside **-dēnd**), *benefactor*; and the collective plurals **gefīend,** *enemies*; **gefrīend,** *friends*, which were originally neuter collective nouns and declined like **wīte** (§ **355**).

§ **418.** Like **wīgend** are declined **āgend,** *owner*; **beswīcend,** *deceiver*; **ēhtend,** *persecutor*; **hǣlend,** *Saviour*; **helpend,** *helper*; **hettend,** *enemy*; **ner(i)gend,** *Saviour*; **sēmend,** *arbitrator*; **wealdend,** *ruler*; for further examples, see § **601**.

### 5. Stems in -os, -es.

§ **419.** This class of nouns corresponds to the Gr. neuters in **-ος**, Lat. **-us**, as Gr. **γένος**, *race*, gen. **γένεος** older ***γένεσος**, Lat. **genus**, gen. **generis**, pl. **genera**. A fairly large number of nouns originally belonged to this class, but owing to various levellings and new formations, of which some took place in the prehistoric period of all the Germanic languages, nearly all the nouns belonging here went over into other declensions in OE. The prim. Ger-

manic forms of a word like **lamb** were: Sing. nom. acc. ***lamþaz**, gen. ***lamþezaz**, ***lamþiziz**, dat. ***lamþizi**; Plur. nom. acc. ***lamþōzō**, gen. ***lamþezōn**, dat. ***lamþezumiz**. After the loss of the singular endings **-az**, **-iz**, **-i**, the following changes took place: from the gen. and dat. sing a new nom. ***lambiz** beside **lamb** was formed. This accounts for the preservation of the **i** in Gothic in such words as **hatis** = OE. **hete**, *hate*, **sigis** = OE. **sige**, *victory*, which would have been ***hats** and ***sigs** in Gothic, had these words ended in **-iz** in prim. Germanic. The new nom. ending **-iz** regularly became **-i** in OE., then it caused umlaut in the stem-syllable and disappeared after long stems, but remained after short stems and later became **-e**, whence forms like nom. sing. **lemb**, **gǣst**, **hlǣw**, **hete**, **sige** beside **lamb**, **gāst**, **hlāw**. After medial **-z-** in the gen. and dat. sing. had become **r** (§ **252**) it was levelled out into the nom. sing. in some nouns, as ***dōgr**, ***hālr** beside ***dōgi**, ***hāli**, then later **dōgor**, **hālor**, older **-ur**, beside **dǣg** (Nth.), **hǣl**. All the nouns which underwent these new formations passed into other declensions partly with change of gender also. Thus, **gāst**, **gǣst**, *spirit, breath*, **sigor**, *victory*, went into the masc. **a**-declension; **hlǣw**, **hlāw**, *mound, hill*, **hrǣ(w)**, **hrā(w)**, also neut., *corpse, carrion*, into the masc. **wa**-declension; **dǣg** (Nth.), *day*, **ge-ban(n)**, *summons*, **gefōg**, *joining, joint*, **geheald**, *keeping, custody*, **gehnāst**, *conflict, strife*, **gewealc**, *rolling*, **sæl**, *hall*, **dōgor**, *day*, **ēagor**, *flood, tide*, **ēar**, *ear of corn*, **hālor**, *salvation, health*, **hrīþer**, **hrȳþer**, *ox*, **salor**, *hall*, **stulor**, *theft*, pl. **hæteru**, *clothes*, into the neut. **a**-declension; **bere**, *barley*, **ege**, *fear*, **hete**, *hate*, **mene**, *necklace*, **sige**, *victory* into the masc. **i**-declension; **oferslege**, *lintel*, **orlege**, *fate*, **sife**, *sieve*, **spere**, *spear*, **flǣsc**, *flesh*, **flīes**, *fleece*, **hǣl**, *health, salvation*, **hilt**, *hilt*, **lǣn**, *loan*, **sweng**, *blow*, into the neuter **i**-declension.

§ **420**. The few remaining nouns formed their gen. and

dat. sing. after the analogy of the neuter **a**-stems. The cases of the plural were regularly developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| SING. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **lamb**, *lamb* | **cealf**, *calf* | **æg**, *egg* |
| Gen. | **lambes** | **cealfes** | **æges** |
| Dat. | **lambe** | **cealfe** | **æge** |
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **lambru** | **cealfru** | **ægru** |
| Gen. | **lambra** | **cealfra** | **ægra** |
| Dat. | **lambrum** | **cealfrum** | **ægrum** |

Beside **lamb** there also occurs **lombor** and sometimes **lemb**; in late OE. the pl. was **lamb, lamba, lambum** after the analogy of the neuter **a**-stems. Beside the Anglian sing. **calf** there also occurs **cælf, celf** with **i**-umlaut.

Like **lamb** are declined **cild** (pl. **cild** beside **cildru**), *child*; **speld**, *splinter, torch*; pl. **brēadru**, *crumbs*.

# CHAPTER XII

## ADJECTIVES

### A. THE DECLENSION OF ADJECTIVES.

§ **421.** In the parent Indg. language nouns and adjectives were declined alike without any distinction in endings, as in Latin, Greek, and Sanskrit. What is called the uninflected form of adjectives in the Germanic languages is a remnant of the time when nouns and adjectives were declined alike. But already in Indo-Germanic the pronominal adjectives had partly nominal and partly pronominal endings as in Sanskrit. In prim. Germanic the endings of the pronominal adjectives were extended to all adjectives.

These remarks apply to what is called in the Germanic languages the strong declension of adjectives.

The so-called weak declension of adjectives is a special Germanic formation by means of the suffixes **-en-**, **-on-**, which were originally used to form nomina agentis, and attributive nouns, as Lat. **edō** (gen. **edōnis**), *glutton*, OE. **slaga**, *slayer*, **wyrhta**, *worker*, gen. **slagan**, **wyrhtan**; Lat. adjectives **catus**, *sly, cunning*, **rūfus**, *red, red-haired*, **silus**, *pug-nosed*, beside the proper names **Catō** (gen. **Catōnis**), lit. *the sly one*, **Rūfō**, *the red-haired man*, **Silō**, *the pug-nosed man*; and similarly in OE. **blæc**, *black*, **frōd**, *wise, old*, **hālig**, *holy*, beside the proper names **Blaca**, **Frōda**, **Hālga**. In like manner Goth. **blinds**, OE. **blind**, *blind*, beside Goth. OE. **blinda**, which originally meant, *the blind man*; Goth. **ahma sa weiha**, lit. *ghost the holy one* Such nouns came to be used attributively at an early period, and then later as adjectives. And already in prim. Germanic this weak declension became the rule when the adjective followed the definite article, as **Wulfmǣr se geonga**, *Wulfmǣr the Young*, OHG. **Ludowīg ther snello**, *Ludwig the Brave*, cp. NHG. **Karl der Grosse**. At a later period, but still in prim. Germanic, the two kinds of adjectives—strong and weak—became differentiated in use. When the one and when the other form was used in OE. is a question of syntax. There were adjectival **n-** stems in the parent Indg. language, but they did not have vocalic stems beside them as is the case in the Germanic languages. **eall**, *all*, **genōg**, *enough*, **manig**, *many*, and **ōþer**, *second*, were always declined according to the strong declension. Nearly all other adjectives can be declined according to either declension.

The strong form is used predicatively in the positive and superlative degrees; and when the adjective is used attributively without any other defining word, as **wæs sēo fǣmne geong**, *the woman was young*; **þā menn sindon**

**gōde,** *the men are good*; **þus wǣron þā latestan fyrmeste,** *thus were the last, first.* In the vocative the weak form exists beside the strong, as **þū lēofa dryhten,** *thou dear Lord*; **þū riht cyning,** *thou just king.*

The weak form is used after the definite article, and after demonstrative and possessive pronouns, as **se ofermōda cyning,** *the proud king*; **þæs ēadigan weres,** *of the blessed man*; **þes ealda mann,** *this old man*; **on þissum andweardan dæge,** *on this present day*; **mīn lēofa sunu,** *my dear son*; **þurh·þīne æþelan hand,** *through thy noble hand.* In poetry the weak form often occurs where in prose the strong form would be used.

NOTE.—When the same adjective refers both to masc. and fem. beings, it is put in the neut. plural, as **Wit þus baru ne magon būtū ætsomne wesan,** *We (Adam and Eve) may not both together be thus here naked*; cp. Goth. **wēsun garaíhta ba in andwaírþja guþs,** O.Icel. **þau vǫ́ro rētlǫ́t bǣþe fyr guþe,** OHG. **siu wārun rehtiu beidu fora gote,** *they (Zacharias and Elizabeth) were both righteous before God.*

§ **422.** In OE. the adjectives are declined as strong or weak. They have three genders, and the same cases as nouns with the addition of an instrumental in the masc. and neuter singular.

### 1. THE STRONG DECLENSION.

§ **423.** The endings of the strong declension are partly nominal and partly pronominal, the latter are printed in italics for **glæd,** *glad,* and **blind,** *blind.* The nominal endings are those of the **a-, ō**-declensions. The strong declension is divided into pure **a-, ō**-stems, **ja-, jō**-stems, and **wa-, wō**-stems, like the corresponding nouns. The original **i-** and **u**-stems passed over almost entirely into this declension in prehistoric OE. In OE. the **ja-, jō**-stems and the **wa-, wō**-stems only differed from the pure **a-, ō**-stems in the masc. and fem. nom. singular and the neut. nom. acc. singular.

§ **424.** *a.* PURE **a-, ō**-STEMS.

| | *Masc.* | *Neut.* | *Fem.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| SING. | | | |
| Nom. | glæd, *glad* | glæd | gladu, -o |
| Acc. | glæd*ne* | glæd | glade |
| Gen. | glades | glades | glæd*re* |
| Dat. | glad*um* | glad*um* | glæd*re* |
| Instr. | glade | glade | |
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | glad*e* | gladu, -o | glade, -a |
| Gen. | glæd*ra* | glæd*ra* | glæd*ra* |
| Dat. | gladum | gladum | gladum |
| SING. | | | |
| Nom. | blind, *blind* | blind | blind |
| Acc. | blind*ne* | blind | blinde |
| Gen. | blindes | blindes | blind*re* |
| Dat. | blind*um* | blind*um* | blind*re* |
| Instr. | blinde | blinde | |
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc | blind*e* | blind | blinde, -a |
| Gen. | blind*ra* | blind*ra* | blind*ra* |
| Dat. | blindum | blindum | blindum |

The prim. Germanic forms of **blind** were: Masc. sing. nom. ***blinđaz** (Goth. **blinds**), acc. ***blinđanōn** (Goth. **blindana**), gen. ***blinđesa, -asa,** dat. ***blinđommō, -ē** (Goth. **blindamma**), instr. (loc) ***blinđai**; plur. nom. ***blinđai** (Goth. **blindái**), acc. ***blinđanz** (Goth. **blindans**), gen ***blinđaizõn,** dat. ***blinđomiz.** Neut. nom. acc. sing. ***blinđan** (Goth. **blind**), nom. acc. pl. ***blinđō** (Goth. **blinda**). Fem. sing. nom. ***blinđō** (Goth. **blinda**), acc. ***blinđōn** (Goth. **blinda**), gen. ***blinđizõz** (cp. Goth. **þizōs,** *of the*), dat. ***blinđizai** (cp. Goth. **þizái,** *to the*); pl. nom. acc. ***blinđõz** (Goth. **blindōs**), gen. ***blinđaizõn,** dat. ***blinđōmiz.**

On the syncope of the medial vowel in **blindne, blindra, blindre,** see § **221**; after the analogy of such forms it was also dropped in adjectives with short stem-syllables. In late OE. **-era, -ere** are common after both long and short stem-syllables. The nom. acc. neut. pl. and nom. sing. fem. go back to prim. Germanic ***blinđō,** the **-ō** of which became **-u** (§ **214**) and then disappeared after long stems (§ **215**), whence **blind** beside **gladu.** In late WS. the masc. nom. acc. pl. form was generally used for the neuter; and occasionally the **-u** of the short stems was extended to the long. On the **u** in **blindum,** see § **218**; the **-um** became **-un, -on-, -an** in late OE. (§ **284**). **blindra** goes back to prim. OE. ***blindæra, *blindera,** with **æ, e** from the masc. and neut. gen. singular. This form then came to be used for the feminine also. The remaining forms require no comment, as they are regularly developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms.

§ **425.** On the interchange between **æ** and **a** in the declension of **glæd,** see § **54,** Note 3. Like **glæd** are declined the monosyllabic adjectives with short stems, as **bær,** *bare*; **blæc,** *black*; **hræd,** *quick*; **hwæt,** *brisk, active*; **læt,** *slow*; **smæl,** *tender, small*; **sæd,** *satiated*; **wær,** *wary, cautious*; **dol,** *foolish*; **fram,** *active, bold*; **frec,** *bold*; **frum,** *original, first*; **gram,** *angry, fierce*; **hol,** *hollow*; **hnot,** *bald*; **til,** *good, useful*; **trum,** *firm, strong*; **wan,** *wanting, deficient*; **ānlic,** *solitary* (for other examples, see § **634**); **angsum,** *troublesome* (for other examples, see § **636**).

§ **426.** Like **blind** are declined the monosyllabic adjectives with long stems, as **beald,** *bold*; **beorht,** *bright*; **blāc,** *pale*; **brūn,** *brown*; **brād,** *broad*; **ceald,** *cold*; **cūþ,** *known, familiar*; **dēad,** *dead*; **dēaf,** *deaf*; **dēop,** *deep*; **deorc,** *dark*; **dumb,** *dumb*; **eald,** *old*; **earg,** *cowardly*; **earm,** *poor*; **forht,** *fearful, timid*; **frōd,** *wise, old*; **fūl,** *foul*; **fūs,** *ready*; **gefōg (gefōh),** *joint*; **genōg (genōh),** *enough*; **geong,** *young*; **georn,** *eager*; **gnēaþ,** *niggardly*; **gōd,** *good*; **grǣg,**

*grey*; **grēat**, *large*; **hāl**, *whole, sound*; **hār**, *hoary*; **hās**, *hoarse*; **healt**, *halt, lame*; **hēan**, *lowly, despised*; **hold**, *gracious*; **hrōr**, *active, brave*; **hwīt**, *white*; **lang**, *long*; **lāþ**, *hateful*; **lēas**, *free from, faithless*; **lēof**, *dear*; **ranc**, *proud*; **rēad**, *red*; **riht**, *right, straight*; **rōf**, *brave, strong*; **rōt**, *glad, cheerful*; **rūm**, *roomy*; **sār**, *sore*; **scearp**, *sharp*; **scīr**, *bright, shining*; **scort**, *short*; **sēoc**, *sick*; **sōþ**, *true*; **stēap**, *steep, lofty*; **stearc**, *stiff*; **stīþ**, *stiff, rigid*; **strang**, *strong*; **swift**, *swift*; **swīþ**, *strong*; **torht**, *bright*; **trāg**, *lazy, bad*; **þearl**, *severe*; **wǣt**, *wet*; **wāc**, *weak*; **wealt**, *unsteady*; **wearm**, *warm*; **wīd**, *wide*; **wīs**, *wise*; **wlanc**, *proud*; **wōd**, *mad*; **wrǣst**, *firm, strong*; **wrāþ**, *wroth, angry*; **wund**, *wounded*; **fyrn** (orig. **i**-stem), *old, ancient*; **cōl** (orig. **u**-stem), *cool*; **heard** (orig. **u**-stem), *hard*. The double consonants were simplified in the inflected forms before other consonants (§ **259**) in words like **dunn**, *dun*; **eall**, *all*; **feorr**, *far*; **full**, *full*; **gewiss**, *certain, sure*; **grimm**, *grim*; **snell**, *ready, active*. For examples of adjectives like **æþelcund**, *of noble origin*; **ānfeald**, *single*; **ārfæst**, *virtuous*; **ārlēas**, *impious*, see Adjectival Suffixes, §§ **623**, **633**.

§ **427**.

| | *Masc.* | *Neut.* | *Fem.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| SING. | | | |
| Nom. | **hēah**, *high* | **hēah** | **hēa** |
| Acc. | **hēa(n)ne** | **hēah** | **hēa** |
| Gen. | **hēas** | **hēas** | **hēa(r)re** |
| Dat. | **hēa(u)m** | **hēa(u)m** | **hēa(r)re** |
| Instr. | **hēa** | **hēa** | |
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **hēa** | **hēa** | **hēa** |
| Gen. | **hēa(r)ra** | **hēa(r)ra** | **hēa(r)ra** |
| Dat. | **hēa(u)m** | **hēa(u)m** | **hēa(u)m** |

**hēanne, hēarra, hēarre** were due to the assimilation of **hn** and **hr**; and **hēane, hēara, hēare** arose from the regu-

lar loss of **h** before **n, r** (§ **329**, 2). In **hēaum** the **u** was restored after the analogy of forms like **gladum, blindum.** The instr., masc. and fem. nom. pl., and fem. acc. singular **hēa** was from older ***hēahe;** and the neut. nom. acc. pl. and fem. nom. singular from older ***hēahu;** masc. and neut. gen. sing. from ***hēahes.** See § **139.** Late OE. forms like gen. **hēages,** dat. **hēage,** nom. pl. **hēage** beside older **hēas, hēa(u)m, hēa** were formed after the analogy of such words as gen. **gefōges, genōges** beside nom. **gefōh, genōh** (§ **323**).

§ **428.** Like **hēah** are declined **fāh,** *hostile*; **flāh,** *deceitful*; **hrēoh,** *rude, rough, wild*; **nēah,** *nigh, near*; **rūh,** *rough*; **scēoh,** *shy*; **tōh,** *tough*; **wōh,** *crooked, bad.* **sceolh,** *awry, squinting*; **þweorh,** *cross, perverse,* dropped the **h** and lengthened the diphthong in the inflected forms, as gen. **scēoles, þwēores,** dat. **scēolum, þwēorum,** cp. § **149.**

§ **429.**

| | | *Masc.* | *Neut.* | *Fem.* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sing. | Nom. | **manig,** *many* | **manig** | **manig** |
| | Acc. | **manigne** | **manig** | **manige** |
| | Gen. | **maniges** | **maniges** | **manigre** |
| | Dat. | **manigum** | **manigum** | **manigre** |
| | Instr. | **manige** | **manige** | |
| Plur. | | | | |
| | Nom. Acc. | **manige** | **manig** | **manige, -a** |
| | Gen. | **manigra** | **manigra** | **manigra** |
| | Dat. | **manigum** | **manigum** | **manigum** |
| Sing. | | | | |
| | Nom. | **hālig,** *holy* | **hālig** | **hāligu, -o** |
| | Acc. | **hāligne** | **hālig** | **hālge** |
| | Gen. | **hālges** | **hālges** | **hāligre** |
| | Dat. | **hālgum** | **hālgum** | **hāligre** |
| | Instr. | **hālge** | **hālge** | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **hālge** | **hāligu, -o** | **hālge, -a** |
| Gen. | **hāligra** | **hāligra** | **hāligra** |
| Dat. | **hālgum** | **hālgum** | **hālgum** |

Original short medial vowels in open syllables regularly remained in trisyllabic forms when the stem-syllable was short. They also remained in closed syllables irrespectively as to whether the stem-syllable was long or short. But they disappeared when the stem-syllable was long. See § **221.** Final **-u** regularly disappeared after a long medial syllable, and also when the stem and the medial syllable were short, but remained when the stem-syllable was long and the medial syllable short. See § **216.** There are many exceptions to the above rules due to analogical formations, as **yfles, hāliges, hālgu** beside older **yfeles, hālges, hāligu,** see § **223,** Note 1. In adjectives ending in **-en, -er,** the combinations **-enne** (masc. acc. sing.), **-erra** (gen. pl.), and **-erre** (fem. gen. dat. sing.) were often simplified to **-ene, -era, -ere** especially in late OE. (§ **259,** 4).

§ **430.** Like **manig** are declined the dissyllabic adjectives with short stems, as **atol,** *terrible, dire*; **bedol,** *suppliant*; **bræsen,** *of brass* (for examples of other adjectives ending in **-en,** see § **625**); **efen,** *even*; **etol,** *gluttonous*; **fægen,** *glad*; **fæger,** *fair*; **flacor;** *flickering*; **flugol,** *fleet, swift*; **forod,** *decayed*; **fracoþ,** *vile, bad*; **hnitol,** *given to butting*; **micel** (see § **223,** Note 1), *large, great*; **nacod,** *naked*; **open,** *open*; **plegol,** *playful*; **recen,** *ready, prompt*; **sicor,** *sure*; **sweotol,** *plain, evident*; **yfel,** *evil*; **wacor,** *vigilant*; **bysig,** *busy* (for other examples, see § **630**); past participles, as **boren,** *borne*; **coren,** *chosen*; **legen,** *lain*; &c.

§ **431.** Like **hālig** are declined the dissyllabic adjectives with long stems, as **ācol,** *timid, frightened*; **ǣt(t)ren,** *poisonous* (for examples of other adjectives ending in **-en,** see § **625**); **āgen,** *own*; **bēogol,** *agreeing*; **bit(t)er,** *bitter*;

**brægden,** *deceitful*; **crīsten,** *christian*; **dēagol, dīegol,** *secret*; **ēacen,** *great, increased*; **earfoþ,** *difficult*; **frettol,** *greedy*; **geōmor,** *sad*; **gylden,** *golden*; **hādor,** *bright*; **hǣþen,** *heathen*; **hlūt(t)or,** *clear*; **īdel,** *vain*; **lȳtel,** *little*; **ōþer** (§ **223**), *second*; **snot(t)or,** *wise*; **stǣgel,** *steep*; **blōdig,** *bleeding*; **cræftig,** *skilful*; **ēadig,** *rich, happy* (for other examples, see § **630**); **cildisc,** *childish* (for other examples see § **632**); past participles, as **bunden,** *bound*; **holpen,** *helped*, see § **442.**

*b.* **ja-, jō-**STEMS.

§ **432.** In the **ja-, jō-**stems it is necessary to distinguish between those stems which were originally long and those which became long by the West Germanic doubling of consonants (§ **254**). The latter class were declined in OE. like the pure **a-, ō-**stems ending in double consonants (§ **426**), such are: **gesibb,** *akin, related*; **midd,** *middle*; **nytt,** *useful*. The regular form of the nom. sing. masc. and neut. of a word like **midd** would be ***mide,** see § **274.**

§ **433.**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| SING. | *Masc.* | *Neut.* | *Fem.* |
| Nom. | **wilde,** *wild* | **wilde** | **wildu, -o** |
| Acc. | **wildne** | **wilde** | **wilde** |
| Gen. | **wildes** | **wildes** | **wildre** |
| Dat. | **wildum** | **wildum** | **wildre** |
| Instr. | **wilde** | **wilde** | |
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **wilde** | **wildu, -o** | **wilde, -a** |
| Gen. | **wildra** | **wildra** | **wildra** |
| Dat. | **wildum** | **wildum** | **wildum** |

The only difference in declension between the original long **ja-, jō-**stems and the long pure **a-, ō-**stems is in the masc. nom. sing., neut. nom. acc. sing. and plural, and the fem. nom. singular. **wilde** (masc. nom. sing.) is regularly developed

from prim. Germanic ***wilþjaz,** and the neut. nom. acc. sing. from ***wilþjan;** **wildu** (fem. nom. sing. and neut. nom. acc. plural) was formed on analogy with the short pure **a**-stems (§ **424**), the regular form would be ***wild** (see § **215**). Double consonants were simplified before or after other consonants (§ **259**), as masc. acc. sing. **þynne,** *thin,* **fǣcne,** *deceitful,* **ierne,** *angry,* from ***þynnne, *fǣcnne, *ierrne;** fem. gen. dat. sing. **gīfre,** *greedy,* **ierre** from ***gīfrre, *ierrre.** When **n, r** came to stand between two consonants the first of which was not a nasal or liquid, they became vocalic and then developed an **e** before them, as masc. acc. sing. **gīferne** from ***gīfrne;** fem. gen. dat. sing. **fǣcenre** from ***fǣcnre.** Nearly all the old long **i**- and **u**-stems went over into this declension in prehistoric OE.

§ **434.** Like **wilde** are declined a large number of adjectives, as **æltǣwe,** *entire;* **æþele,** *noble;* **andfenge,** *acceptable;* **andrysne,** *terrible;* **ānlīepe,** *single;* **blīþe,** *joyful;* **brēme,** *famous;* **brȳce,** *useful;* **cēne,** *bold;* **clǣne,** *clean;* **cȳme,** *comely, beautiful;* **cynde,** *natural;* **dīere, dēore,** *dear;* **dierne,** *hidden;* **drȳge,** *dry;* **ēce,** *eternal;* **egle,** *troublesome;* **ēste,** *gracious;* **fǣcne,** *deceitful;* **fǣge,** *fated;* **fēowerfēte,** *four-footed;* **filde,** *level (of land);* **flēde,** *in flood;* **forþgenge,** *effective;* **frēcne,** *dangerous, wicked;* **frem(e)de,** *foreign;* **frēo** (§ **104**), *free;* **gecnǣwe,** *conscious of;* **gecwēme,** *pleasant;* **gedēfe,** *becoming, fit;* **gefēre,** *accessible;* **gehende,** *handy;* **gemǣne,** *common;* **genǣme,** *acceptable;* **gesīene,** *visible;* **getenge,** *near to;* **getrīewe,** *faithful;* **gīfre,** *greedy;* **grēne,** *green;* **hlǣne,** *lean;* **hnæsce,** *soft, tender;* **ierre,** *angry;* **īeþe,** *easy;* **lǣne,** *temporary;* **lætrǣde,** *deliberate;* **līþe,** *gentle;* **mǣre,** *famous;* **manþwǣre,** *humane;* **medeme,** *moderate;* **mēþe,** *tired;* **milde,** *mild;* **myrge,** *merry;* **nīewe, nīwe** (§ **90**), *new;* **oferǣte,** *gluttonous;* **ofersprǣce,** *loquacious;* **ormǣte,** *immeasurable;* **rēþe,** *fierce;* **rīce,** *powerful;* **rīpe,** *ripe;* **sǣne,** *slow;*

**sammǣle,** *agreed*; **scīene,** *beautiful*; **sēfte,** *soft*; **slīþe,** *cruel, savage*; **smēþe,** *smooth*; **smylte,** *mild, serene*; **stille,** *still*; **strenge,** *strong*; **swēte,** *sweet*; **swīge,** *silent*; **sȳfre,** *pure*; **þicce,** *thick*; **þīestre,** *dark, gloomy*; **þrifingre,** *three fingers thick*; **þrīste,** *rash, daring*; **þriwintre,** *three years old*; **þynne,** *thin*; **þyrre,** *withered*; **unhīere,** *horrible*; **ūþgenge,** *fugitive*; **wēste,** *waste, barren*; **wierþe,** *worthy*; **wrǣne,** *wanton.* In like manner are declined the present participles (§ **441**). For examples of adjectives like **æppelbǣre,** *apple-bearing*; **coppede,** *topped, polled*; **hālwende,** *healthful*, see Adjectival Suffixes, §§ **624, 638.**

### *c.* wa-, wō-STEMS.

§ **435.**

| SING. | *Masc.* | *Neut.* | *Fem.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nom. | **gearu, -o,** *ready* | **gearu, -o** | **gearu, -o** |
| Acc. | **gearone** | **gearu, -o** | **gearwe** |
| Gen. | **gearwes** | **gearwes** | **gearore** |
| Dat. | **gearwum** | **gearwum** | **gearore** |
| Instr. | **gearwe** | **gearwe** | |
| PLUR. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **gearwe** | **gearu, -o** | **gearwe, -a** |
| Gen. | **gearora** | **gearora** | **gearora** |
| Dat. | **gearwum** | **gearwum** | **gearwum** |

**w** became vocalized to **u** (later **o**) when final and before consonants in prehistoric OE. (§ **265**); whence masc. nom. sing., neut. nom. acc. sing. **gearu** from ***ȝarw-az, -an.** The **u** had become **o** before consonants in the oldest period of the language, as **gearone, gearora.** The fem. nom. sing. and neut. nom. acc. pl. are from older ***ȝarwu** with loss of **w** before the following **u** (§ **266**). The dat. **gearwum** for ***gearum** was a new formation made from forms like **gearwes, gearwe,** where the **w** was regular. On forms like gen. **gearuwes, gearowes** beside **gearwes,** see § **220.**

§ **436.** Like **gearu** are declined **basu, beasu,** *purple*; **calu,** *bald*; **cylu,** *spotted*; **fealu,** *fallow*; **geolu,** *yellow*; **hasu, heasu,** *grey, tawny*; **mearu,** *tender*; **nearu,** *narrow*; **salu, sealu,** *dusky, dark.*

§ **437.** The adjectives which had a long vowel or long diphthong in the stem reintroduced the **w** into the nominative from the inflected forms (§ **265**) and then came to be declined like pure long **a-, ō-**stems (§ **424**), such are: **fēawe,** *few*; **gedēaw,** *dewy*; **gehlēow,** *sheltered*; **gesēaw,** *succulent*; **glēaw,** *wise*; **hnēaw,** *stingy*; **hrēaw,** *raw*; **rōw,** *quiet, calm*; **slāw,** *slow*; **þēow,** *servile.*

*d.* **i**-STEMS.

§ **438.** Of the adjectives which originally belonged to this class, the long stems took final **-i** (later **-e**) from analogy with the short stems and then both classes went over into the **ja**-declension in prehistoric OE. The old short **i**-stems are still recognizable by the fact that they do not have double consonants in the stem-syllable. Examples are: **bryce,** *brittle*; **gemyne,** *remembering*; **swice,** *deceitful*; and of old long **i**-stems: **blīþe** (Goth. **bleiþs**), *joyful*; **brȳce** (Goth. **brūks**), *useful*; **clǣne,** *clean*; **gecwēme,** *pleasant*; **gedēfe** (Goth. **gadōfs**), *becoming, fit*; **gemǣne** (Goth. **gamáins**), *common*; **gesīene** (cp. Goth. **anasiuns**), *visible*; **grēne,** *green*; **scīene,** *beautiful*; **swēte,** *sweet*; &c.

*e.* **u**-STEMS.

§ **439.** Of the adjectives which originally belonged to this class only two have preserved traces of the old **u**-declension, namely nom. sing. **cwicu, c(w)ucu,** *alive,* masc. acc. sing. **cucone,** and nom. **wlacu,** *warm, tepid.* And even these two adjectives generally have nom. **cwic, wlæc** and are declined like short pure **a**-stems. All the other adjectives passed over into the **a-, ja-,** or **wa**-declension in prehistoric OE., as **heard** (Goth. **hardus**), *hard*; **egle**

(Goth. **aglus**), *troublesome*; **hnesce, hnæsce** (Goth. **hnasqus**), *soft, tender*; **twelfwintre** (Goth. **twalibwintrus**), *twelve years old*; **þyrre** (Goth. **þaúrsus**), *dry, withered*; **glēaw** (Goth. **glaggwus**), *wise*.

### 2. The Weak Declension.

§ **440.**

| Sing. | *Masc.* | *Neut.* | *Fem.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nom. | **blinda,** *blīnd* | **blinde** | **blinde** |
| Acc. | **blindan** | **blinde** | **blindan** |
| Gen. | **blindan** | **blindan** | **blindan** |
| Dat. | **blindan** | **blindan** | **blindan** |
| Plur. | | | |
| Nom. Acc. | **blindan** | **blindan** | **blindan** |
| Gen. | **blindra, -ena** | **blindra, -ena** | **blindra, -ena** |
| Dat. | **blindum** | **blindum** | **blindum** |

The weak declension of adjectives has the same endings as the weak declension of nouns, except that the adjectives generally have the strong ending **-ra** (§ **424**) instead of **-(e)na** in the gen. plural. Beside the regular dat. pl. ending **-um** there also occurs at an early period **-an** which was taken over from the nom. acc. plural. In trisyllabic adjectives the medial vowel remained after short stems, but disappeared after long stems, as **wacora, wacore,** *vigilant,* beside **hālga, hālge,** *holy* (§ **221**). On adjectives like **hēa,** *high,* gen. **hēan,** see § **427**. In like manner are declined the **ja-** and **wa-**stems, as **wilda, wilde,** *wild*; **gearwa, gearwe,** *ready*.

### 3. The Declension of Participles.

§ **441.** In the parent language the stem of the present participle ended in **-nt,** as in Lat. **ferent-**, Gr. **φέροντ-**, *bearing*. The masc. and neut. were originally declined like consonant stems (§ **416**). The fem. nom. originally ended in **-ī** which was shortened to **-i** (§ **214**) in prehistoric OE. (cp. Goth.

**frijōndi,** fem. *friend*). The **·i** of the feminine was extended to the masculine and neuter, which was the cause of their passing over into the **ja**-declension (§ **433**). In OE. the pres. participle was declined strong or weak like an ordinary adjective. When used predicatively it often had the uninflected form for all genders in the nom. and accusative.

§ **442.** The past participle, like the present, was declined strong or weak like an ordinary adjective. When strong it was declined like **manig** or **hālig** (§ **429**) according as the stem-syllable was short or long; and similarly when it was declined weak (§ **440**). When used predicatively it generally had the uninflected form for all genders. A small number of past participles of strong verbs have **i**-umlaut of the stem-vowel, because in prim. Germanic, beside the ordinary ending **·énaz** = Indg. **·énos,** there also existed **·íniz** = Indg. **·énis,** hence forms like **ǣgen** beside **āgen,** *own*; **cymen** beside **cumen,** *come*; **slegen** beside **slægen, slagen,** *slain*; **tygen** from ***tuǥiniz** beside **togen** from ***tuǥenaz,** *drawn.*

## B. The Comparison of Adjectives.

### 1. The Comparative Degree.

§ **443.** The Indg. parent language had several suffixes by means of which the comparative degree was formed. But in the individual branches of the parent language, one of the suffixes generally became more productive than the rest, and in the course of time came to be the principal one from which the comparative was formed, the other suffixes only being preserved in isolated forms. The only Indg. comparative suffix which remained productive in the Germanic languages is **·is·,** which became **·iz·** (= Goth. **·iz·,** OHG. **·ir·,** OE. **·r·**) in prim. Germanic by Verner's law. To this suffix was added in prim. Germanic, or probably in the pre-Germanic period, the formative suffix **·en·, ·on·,**

as in Gr. ἡδίων from *σϝᾱδίσων, gen. ἡδίονος, = Goth. **sutiza**, gen. **sutizins**, OHG. **suoziro**, gen. **suoziren**, (**-in**), OE. **swētra**, *sweeter*, gen. **swētran**. This explains why the comparative is declined weak in the oldest periods of the Germanic languages. Beside the suffix **-iz-** there was also in prim. Germanic a suffix **-ōz-** (Goth. **-ōz-**, OHG. **-ōr-**, OE. **-r-**) which did not exist in Indo-Germanic. This suffix is a special Germanic new formation, and arose from the comparative of adverbs whose positive originally ended in **-ō̃**, Indg. **-ō̃d** (§ **554**). And then at a later period it became extended to adjectives.

In OE. polysyllabic adjectives formed with derivative suffixes and compound adjectives had the Germanic suffix **-ōz-**; **ja**-stems the suffix **-iz-**; and uncompounded pure **a**-stems mostly had **-ōz-**. Prim. Germanic **-izō̃** (= Goth. **-iza**, OHG. **-iro**) and **-ōzō̃** (= Goth. **-ōza**, OHG. **-ōro**) fell together in **-ra** in OE., so that, except in the **ja**-stems, the presence or absence of umlaut is the only indication as to which of the two suffixes **-ra** goes back. Only a small number of adjectives have umlaut in OE., of which the most common are:

| | |
|---|---|
| **brād**, *broad* | **brǣdra** beside **brādra** |
| **eald**, *old* | **ieldra** (Goth. **alþiza**) |
| **feorr**, *far* | **fierra** |
| **geong**, *young* | **giengra**, **gingra** |
| **grēat**, *great* | **grīetra** |
| **hēah**, *high* | **hīehra**, **hīerra** beside **hēahra** |
| **lang**, *long* | **lengra** |
| **sceort**, *short* | **sciertra** |
| **strang**, *strong* | **strengra**. |

Examples without umlaut in the comparative degree are: **ēadig**, *happy*, **earm**, *poor*, **fægen**, *glad*, **fæger**, *fair*, **gearu**, **-o**, *ready*, **glæd**, *glad*, **grimm**, *grim*, **hālig**, *holy*, **lēof**, *dear*, **nēah**, *near*, comparative **ēadigra**, **earmra**, **fægenra**,